MUSIC ▼

BRIGHT STAR

Singer-songwriter Aditya Rikhari is among the country's fastest-rising pop musicians



Aditya Rikhari isn't a household name, yet but all signs indicate he's on the home stretch to nationwide fame. The 25-year-old vocalist and composer just spent 17 weeks at No.1 on Spotify's Top Songs chart with his single 'Sahiba', tying a record for the most weeks at the top for a non-soundtrack single. 'Sahiba' matched the run of 'Maan Meri Jaan' by rapper-singer King, who, incidentally, appeared alongside Rikhari as a mentor on the singing talent competition web series *I-Popstar*.

They're just two of the many milestones Rikhari has already crossed in his relatively short career—the most recent was playing his first stadium show, at the NSCI Dome in Mumbai, in January. The New Delhi-based musician, whose favourite phrase is "with God's grace", says that there have been several such markers that have encouraged him to reach the point of stardom he enjoys among the youth today.

The first was when his 2020 single 'Kya Karein', which he released while in college, crossed 100,000 streams after he got popular YouTube channel Last

THE LISTICLE ▸ Upcoming musical performances you should not miss



▲ **FEB. 21-22** | *Qila Gobindgarh, Amritsar*

The Sacred Amritsar

Set against the historic backdrop of Qila Gobindgarh, this two-day festival blends mysticism, folk energy and contemporary sound. Day 1 features the nuanced textures of the Anirudh Varma Collective alongside the iconic presence of Usha Uthup. Day 2 brings the high-voltage folk fusion of The Kutle Khan Project, culminating in the soulful power of Kailash Kher. Expect music, memory and shared *sukoon*.

▼ **FEB. 22** | *DMC KVP Grounds, Salem*

Ilaiyaraaja Live in Concert: Salem Rajadhi Raaja

This concert sees the legendary Ilaiyaraaja take the stage in Salem. Revered across generations, his compositions carry a remarkable emotional range, blending melody, drama and cultural memory. The evening offers audiences a rare opportunity to experience his music live, revisiting works that continue to shape Indian cinema and popular memory.

